

A Choice That Has a Cost: Evidence on the Table

有代价的选择：摆上桌面的证据

Theme: 心理、决策、责任与人生选择 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6,127

English Story

The evidence meeting was held **tonight because** the news could not wait, and the argument on the table was about a **defective pearl**. “I **believe** the report and I cannot **approve** it,” the auditor said. “**Everything upon** it rests on one page, and that page was written **prior** to the test.”

The **dispute concerning** the **twentieth** chapter was simple: **accept** the figure or **deny** it. “You **insist** that we **respond tonight**,” Lin said. “I would rather **remind** you that a **compelling thesis** can still be wrong.” A **generous** reader would **argue** the same point, and a **cop** at the door would not.

The group had promised not to **pretend**. “We will **declare** the error and we will not **seize** the moment to look good,” Maya wrote. “**Onto** every page we will put the name of the person who checked it, and **okay** means checked.”

The **prior** year had been wound **backwards**: a **nightly** habit of re-doing each report, an **entrepreneurial** push that frightened the volunteers, and a **forgetful** editor who had misplaced one page. “**Weep** if you like,” the auditor said, “but **stabilize** the process first.”

The surrounding argument was about the **underwear** factory and the couple who owned it. “It is **too** easy to **rob** a small firm of its name,” Lin said. “A fine is not the same as a fair verdict, and an exception is not a rule.”

The choice of the **twentieth** chapter was to publish **everything except** the private correspondence, and to **try** the whole record against the purpose it claimed. “A **generous** account is not a flattering one,” the auditor said, and the meeting closed without an argument. Age is different from death, and during the year we decided to keep every point about the effect. The fine was never news, the purpose was never just, and the couple who built it seemed to be under a different sky. The choice was to decide during the same meeting, and to choose the harder option; it was never only about the fine, and the news, the point, and the effect were the same as before. **Although** we cannot **swear** to every page, we **welcome** the check, and we will not **entertain** a version that hides it.

中文翻译

证据会议在今晚召开，因为消息等不了，而桌上的争论关乎一颗有缺陷的珍珠。“我相信这份报告，但我无法批准它，”审计员说，“它之上的一切都依赖一页纸，而那一页是在测试之前写的。”

关于第二十章的争论很简单：接受这个数字，或者否认它。“你坚持要我们今晚回应，”林伟说，“我更愿意提醒你，一篇有说服力的论文仍然可能是错的。”一位慷慨的读者会提出同样的观点，而门口那位警察不会。

小组承诺过不假装。“我们会声明这个错误，也不会抓住这个时机让自己好看，”曼雅写道，“在每一页上，我们都会写上核对者的名字，而‘可以’的意思就是已核对。”

前一年是被倒着缠回去的：每晚重做每份报告的习气、一次吓得志愿者发抖的创业式推进，以及一位把某一页放错了地方的健忘编辑。“你想哭就哭吧，”审计员说，“但请先把流程稳住。”

外围的争论关乎那家内衣厂和拥有它的那对夫妇。“太容易就剥夺一家小公司的名声了，”林伟说，“一笔罚款不等于一个公正的裁决，而一个例外不是一条规则。”

第二十章的选择是：除了私人通信以外全部公开，并尝试用整份记录去检验它所声称的目的。“一份慷慨的记述不是一份谄媚的记述，”审计员说，而会议在没有争执的情况下结束。年龄不同于死亡，而在这一年里我们决定保留关于那个影响的每一个要点。那笔罚款从来不是新闻，那个目的从来不是公正的，而建造它的那对夫妇似乎生活在另一片天空下。这个选择是在同一次会议上作出决定，并选择更难的那个选项；它从来不只关乎那笔罚款，而新闻、那个要点以及那个影响，都和从前一样。虽然我们无法为每一页发誓，但我们欢迎这次核对，也不会去迎合一个把它藏起来的版本。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
because bi'kɔ:z POS: conj	conj. 因为 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: conj. By or for the cause that; on this account that; for the; reason that.; conj. In order that; that.
too tu: POS: adv	adv. 也, 非常, 太 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r to a degree exceeding normal or proper limits; r in addition
try traɪ POS: n	n. 尝试, 试验, 审理, 审判; vt. 试, 尝试, 试验, 考验, 审问, 提炼; vi. 尝试, 试图 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make an effort or attempt; v. give pain or trouble to; v. test the limits of; v. melt (fat or lard) in order...
although ə'lðəu POS: conj	conj. 虽然, 尽管 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: conj. Grant all this; be it that; supposing that;; notwithstanding; though.
believe bi'li:v POS: v	v. 相信 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. accept as true; take to be true; v. be confident about something; v. follow a credo; have a faith; be a beli...
everything 'evriθɪŋ POS: pron	pron. 每件事物, 所有事物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. Whatever pertains to the subject under consideration;; all things.
upon ə'pɒn POS: prep	prep. 在...之上, 迫近, 紧接着 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: prep. On; — used in all the senses of that word, with which it; is interchangeable.
accept ək'sept POS: vt	vt. 接受, 承认, 同意, 相信, 赞成, 承担, 承兑, 采纳, 接纳, 容忍; vi. 同意 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. consider or hold as true; v. receive willingly something given or offered; v. give an affirmative reply to;...
argue 'ɑ:ɡju POS: vi	vi. 提出理由, 争论, 辩论; vt. 主张, 辩论, 证明, 说服 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. present reasons and arguments; v. have an argument about something; v. give evidence of
tonight tə'naɪt POS: n	n. 今晚, 今夜; adv. 今晚, 今夜 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the present or immediately coming night; r. during the night of the present day
respond rɪ'spɒnd POS: vt	vt. 以...回答; vi. 回答, 响应, 回报, 有反应, 承担责任 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. respond favorably or as hoped
onto 'ɒntu: POS: prep	prep. 在...之上 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: prep. On the top of; upon; on. See On to, under On, prep.
okay əj'keɪ POS: a	a. 好, 可以, 行, 对, 好吗, 很好; adv. 好, 可以, 行, 对, 好吗, 很好; n. 同意, 签认, 批准, 认可; vt. ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in a satisfactory or adequate manner; ('alright' is a nonstandard variant of 'all right')
deny di'naɪ POS: v	v. 否认, 拒绝 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. declare untrue; contradict; v. refuse to accept or believe; v. refuse to grant, as of a petition or request; ...
insist ɪn'sɪst POS: v	v. 坚持, 坚决主张, 强调 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be emphatic or resolute and refuse to budge; v. assert to be true
remind rɪ'maɪnd POS: vt	vt. 提醒, 使想起 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. put in the mind of someone
declare di'kleə POS: v	v. 宣布, 声明, 申报, 断言 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. state emphatically and authoritatively; v. state firmly; v. declare to be; v. authorize payments of
welcome 'welkəm POS: n	n. 欢迎, 欢迎词; a. 受欢迎的, 可随意的, 可喜的; vt. 欢迎, 接待; interj. 欢迎 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of being welcome; n. a greeting or reception; v. accept gladly; v. bid welcome to; greet upon arriv...
surround sə'raʊnd POS: vt	vt. 包围, 环绕, 围绕; n. 围绕物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. extend on all sides of simultaneously; encircle
approve ə'pru:v POS: vt	vt. 赞同, 核准, 为...提供证据; vi. 赞许 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. give sanction to; v. judge to be right or commendable; think well of
except ɪk'sept POS: vt	vt. 除, 除外; vi. 反对; prep. 除了...之外, 若不是, 除非; conj. 只是 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v take exception to; v prevent from being included or considered or accepted
dispute dis'pjʊ:t POS: n	n. 争论; v. 争论 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a disagreement or argument about something important; n. coming into conflict with
cop kɒp POS: n	n. 警官; vt. 抓住 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n uncomplimentary terms for a policeman; v take by theft; v take into custody

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
concerning kən'sə:nɪŋ POS: prep	prep. 关于; [法] 关于 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v be relevant to; v be on the mind of
prior 'praɪə POS: a	a. 更重要的, 较早的, 在先的; n. 小隐修院院长, 大隐修院副院长 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the head of a religious order; in an abbey the prior is next below the abbot
pretend pri'tend POS: v	v. 假装, 伪称, 自命, 自称 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. put forward a claim and assert right or possession of
seize si:z POS: vt	vt. 抓住, 逮捕, 俘获, 没收, 扣押, 掌握; vi. 突然抓住, 利用 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. take hold of; grab; v. take or capture by force; v. hook by a pull on the line; v. affect
generous 'dʒenərəs POS: a	a. 慷慨的, 有雅量的, 大量的, 丰富的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. willing to give and share unstintingly; a. not petty in character and mind; s. more than adequate
swear swəə POS: vt	vt. 发誓, 咒骂, 使宣誓; vi. 发誓, 诅咒; n. 诅咒, 誓言 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. promise solemnly; take an oath; v. make a deposition; declare under oath
backwards 'bækwədʒ POS: adv	adv. 向后 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r at or to or toward the back or rear; r in a manner or order or direction the reverse of normal
twentieth 'twentiθ POS: num	num. 第二十, 二十分之一 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. position 20 in a countable series of things; s. coming next after the nineteenth in position
thesis 'θi:sis POS: n	n. 论题, 论文 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an unproved statement put forward as a premise in an argument
entertain ,ente'teɪn POS: vt	vt. 娱乐, 招待, 怀抱; vi. 款待 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. provide entertainment for; v. take into consideration, have in view
compelling kəm'pelɪŋ POS: a	a. 强制的, 强迫性的, 激发兴趣的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. driving or forcing; s. tending to persuade by forcefulness of argument
frighten 'fraɪn POS: vt	vt. 使惊吓; vi. 惊恐 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cause fear in; v. drive out by frightening
rob rɒb POS: v	v. 抢夺, 抢掠, 剥夺 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. take something away by force or without the consent of the owner
weep wi:p POS: n	n. 哭, 哭泣; vi. 哭泣, 流泪, 哀悼, 滴落; vt. 哭着使..., 悲叹, 滴下 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v shed tears because of sadness, rage, or pain
stabilize 'steɪblaɪz POS: vt	vt. 使安定, 使稳固; vi. 稳定, 安定 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make stable and keep from fluctuating or put into an equilibrium; v. become stable or more stable
underwear 'ʌndəweə POS: n	n. 内衣 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. undergarment worn next to the skin and under the outer garments
pearl pe:l POS: n	n. 珍珠, 珠灰色, 杰出者, 珍贵之物; vt. 用珍珠镶, 使成珠状; vi. 成珠子状, 采珍珠, 用珍珠做 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a smooth lustrous round structure inside the shell of a clam or oyster; much valued as a jewel; v. gather p...
defective di'fektiv POS: a	a. 有缺陷的, 欠缺的; n. 有缺陷的人, 不完全变化词 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. having a defect; s. markedly subnormal in structure or function or intelligence or behavior
entrepreneurial ,ɒntrəprə'nɜ:riəl POS: a	a. 创业的, 具有企业精神的; 企业性质的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to an entrepreneur; s. willing to take risks in order to make a profit
nightly 'naɪtli POS: a	a. 每夜的, 夜间的; adv. 每夜 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. happening every night; r. at the end of each day
forgetful fe'getful POS: a	a. 健忘的, 易忘的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. failing to keep in mind